

SHOWCASE

CLOi SuitBot

In recent times, robots have almost always been mentioned in the news as contenders for human jobs. However, another aspect of investing into robotics is the ability to enhance human abilities. LG seems to be targeting this outcome with the CLOi SuitBot. Demonstrated at IFA 2018, the wearable-tech exoskeleton-esque pair of leg



enhancements stand for LG's first foray into human centred robotics. While it might look like something that has jumped right out of a Robocop movie, its primary purpose is supposed to be enhancing the leg movements of workers - essentially increasing the amount of weight one can lift and the ability to perform certain tasks.

These exoskeleton pants were developed in collaboration with SG Robotics and come with artificial intelligence built in. What this means is that the SuitBot will

be able to learn from the user's movements and biometric data to fine tune its operations for maximum efficiency. Alongside logistics and manufacturing, the SuitBot is also suitable for healthcare cases, helping disabled people overcome the limitations of their own bodies.

Link: <https://dgit.in/CLOiSuitBot>



ABI Zero

Anyone with or working in an industrial environment knows the importance of being able to do proactive, regular inspections while avoiding danger to employees at the same time. Vtrus, a drone manufacturing company and platform, lets users safely navigate indoor environments while the drone generates a 3D map of the surroundings autonomously. This map can be consulted by workers and inspectors in real time.

The need for a drone system separate from those already operational for security and exterior imaging is the degree of accuracy required for factory surveillance. According to Vtrus, the hardware itself is pretty much off the shelf and it is the software that makes the difference. The Vtrus ABI Zero can fly for about 10 minutes, but with the self-docking mechanism and half hour fast charging time, it can give you about six hours of inspection time a day. Combine more than one of these and you have reliable, real time inspection data available throughout the day. The reliability of this data is assured by the ABI's 300,000 depth points 30 times per second capture. While the company is self funded right now, it is hard to imagine that they won't have big companies lined up soon.

Link: <https://dgit.in/Vtrus>

Hoverwheel

It's 2018 and we've already seen patent wars over hoverboards, so yeah, we've pretty much made 'Back to the Future' a reality, albeit a bit late. Brace yourself for the second round because Inventist, the company that originally ended up in a lawsuit battle with Segway, has announced Hoverwheel, a pair of e-skates.

It works just like how you would expect a pair of e-skates in 2018 to work - you step on to them, put your weight in certain direction and glide off into the horizon with a top speed of 7.5mph and a maximum distance of 7 miles. It is based on the same Hovertrax motor design and



weighs about 2.7kg with a load capacity of 81kg. Yes, it also looks and feels pretty similar to Segway's Drift W1 recently debuted at IFA. Why is that interesting?

The lawsuit between the two companies hasn't been resolved yet and the Hoverwheel is currently pending patent. So, this might just lead to another lawsuit altogether, hopefully without as many collateral casualties as the Hoverboard patent war ensued. Meanwhile, we get to enjoy newer modes of electronic transportation that won't work in any realistic scenario whatsoever. Welcome to the future.

Link: <https://dgit.in/Hoverwheel>